

Pro Photo Sorter — Quick Start

Version 1.4.7 · Fully offline · Windows desktop

Install (60 seconds)

1. Double-click **Pro Photo Sorter Setup 1.4.7.exe**
2. If Windows shows a blue "SmartScreen" warning: **More info** → **Run anyway** (indie app, not Microsoft-signed)
3. Wait for the installer to finish. The app opens automatically.

Installed to: `C:\Users\<You>\AppData\Local\Programs\Pro Photo Sorter\`

First launch (2 minutes to a sorted photo)

1. **Splash Screen** welcomes you — click "Get Started". Won't nag again until the next version.
 2. **Sample photos** are pre-loaded so you can practice sorting before touching your own.
 3. Click **Load Source** (top-left) → pick a folder of photos. They appear in the filmstrip.
 4. Click any photo → arrow keys / arrow buttons move through. Press **1–5** to rate.
 5. Open **Tag Manager** (toolbar) → pick a Category → press **Folder / Sub-Folder / Filename**, type a name, **Enter** (repeat). Click a folder to work inside it; ← → ↓ ↑ hop around from the text box. The path preview shows where photos will land, e.g. `Wildlife / Bears / Grizzly / Alaska_Trip`.
 6. Store the photo with **Ctrl+S** (or the Store button). Originals never overwritten — a fresh JPG is written to your destination **with a matching** `.xmp` **sidecar** so Lightroom sees your stars + tags on next import.
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Top 8 gestures

Pro Photo Sorter

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Gesture	What it does
Click chip	Highlights it (visual feedback)
[Select] button in a sub-folder row	Reveals checkboxes for multi-select
Drag chip	Move to another sub-folder (Ctrl-drag = copy)
Paste list button	Bulk-add many chips from a comma/newline/semicolon list
Right-click chip	Move-to / Copy-to menu across every sub-folder
Trash button (Tag Manager header)	See & restore recently deleted chips
 or 	Peek the original inside the Editor
1–5	Star-rate the current photo (0 clears)

Multi-select workflow

1. Expand a sub-folder chevron in the Tag Manager
2. Click **[Select]** on the right side of its "Filename tags for..." header
3. Click chips to tick them — a floating bar appears: 
4. **Delete** sends every ticked chip to Chip Trash (undoable)
5. **Convert** promotes every ticked chip to its own nested sub-folder
6. Or drag any ticked chip → all selected chips move together

Compare view — side-by-side sorting

- Toolbar shows **×1 / ×2 / ×3** — switches how many images sit side-by-side
- **Click any pane** → moves the ACTIVE ring + label there. Images do NOT slide.
- **Store** the active photo → a green "Stored" pulse paints the pane, then the strip shifts one to the left
- **Left/right arrows** → whole strip shifts one; ACTIVE stays pinned in the same pane
- **Filmstrip click** → the clicked photo loads into the ACTIVE pane
- Each pane is independently zoomable (mouse wheel over the pane)

Editor round-trip (v1.4.6+)

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Open a photo in the built-in Editor, crop or rotate, hit Save. The new `<original>_edit_<timestamp>.jpg` inherits every folder tag, filename tag, and the star rating from the original — no re-tagging needed.

Resize crop — orientation + corner drag (v1.4.6+)

In the Resize modal:

- **Auto / Tall / Wide** buttons force the crop into portrait or landscape shape regardless of the source
 - **Four corner handles** let you shrink the crop to 20% of max fit — aspect ratio stays pinned so the print size is honoured
 - **Drag inside** the crop to reposition; **Auto-center** resets to max fit + centered
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Lightroom sync (XMP sidecars)

Every Store now drops a `PhotoName.jpg.xmp` next to the JPEG containing your rating + keywords.

- **Lightroom Classic:** enable *Metadata* → *Read metadata from files*, then right-click the folder → *Read Metadata from Files*
- **Bridge / Capture One:** automatic on next catalog refresh

Your tagging work now travels with the photos.

License / Trial

Every stored file gets `_TRIAL` appended until you paste a license key from Gumroad into Settings. The suffix disappears instantly and you can batch-rename older `_TRIAL` files from the same panel.